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AMH 2010.01

April, 5 2026

Kentucky March 1861 Paper Game Session 4

This essay will discuss the south's reasons to distrust Abraham Lincoln, from the time period of March 1861. This is an occurrence of time, where Lincoln has just made president, bringing in his first inaugural address as of March 4, 1861. It is a time where fury between the idea of slavery between the north and south were at its peak, where the southern states were starting to succeed, having their own country the Confederate States of America, and electing their own leader having their First Inaugural Address on February 18, 1861. Although Lincoln claimed to be neutral in terms of slavery, the south did not trust him.

As Lincoln made his first inaugural address, taking his words word for word may have seemed reassuring that he did not oppose slavery. Saying "I have no purpose to interfere with the institution of slavery. I believe I have no lawful right to do so". It may seem fantastic for the south, but can we really trust his words? If his past is any indication, his statements could be pure deception, possibly easing the south in order to weaken them right now. He has been in the republican party his entire political career is just pushing back on the the rights of the south, in the Freeport Debate, Lincoln actively pushed back on the existing southern right of the Dred Scott decision by questioning "Can the people of a United States Territory, in any lawful way, against the wish of any citizen of the United States, exclude slavery from its limits prior to the formation of a State constitution?", which greatly limited the southern expansion. This is a man whose entire life is built on destroying the very rights and property that we hold, and saying we

should trust that he won't interfere is extremely naive. Lincoln's statement to not interfere with slavery is just a promise said by a crooked lying politician. The deep south may have a deep suspicion that his promise is shallow and is designed to buy time or disarm the South while he consolidates power.

Another reason the south distrusts Lincoln is his contradictory stance on denying secession rights. He claims to be a neutral peacekeeper, seeking to preserve the Union, yet he explicitly denies the fundamental right of states to secede, as in his inauguration saying "It follows from these views that no State upon its own mere motion can lawfully get out of the Union; that resolves and ordinances to that effect are legally void, and acts of violence within authority of the United States are insurrectionary." His actions clearly indicate that he is not a peacekeeper, but rather an aggressor. If he was truly neutral within the sides he would recognize the South's grievances and right to succeed. His outlawing of secession means that he views the seceded states as being in rebellion, not as sovereign entities exercising their rights. Following this logic, implies that would rather force out war rather than a peaceful negotiator and trying to sort this out. It means at the very least that Lincoln is a cheating liar, willing to absolutely despair of his country achieve his goals, his whole goal will absolutely destroy the economy of the country as a whole quoting from the Homespun Lawyer's Speech, "Southern states produce, in foreign exports alone, upwards of \$185,000,000 in value, nearly double that of the North's \$95,000,000, no less than \$87,000,000 flows through New York alone". The south relies heavily on the north for much of its production, so if the south's industry is destroyed, the north's will also be destroyed. A child who does not get their way does not mean they should destroy the entire country because of it. Lincoln is like a child who gets what he wants, but that does not make them entitled to destroy the entire country. Not just the economy will suffer, people will

die, in the True Kentuckian Speech, “thousands of men, good men, who would undoubtedly die if war were to break out, when mothers, wives, and children will ask, “Where is my son? Where is my husband? Where is my father?” Lincoln’s clear direction of war will no doubt, that so many innocent families will be destroyed, from Lincoln’s perspective these deaths will be no more than just numbers, war will be used like a tool. He appears content to sacrifice the commoner, while conveniently maintaining his own distance from personal peril.

Lincoln also had no right to ban secession since the right to succeed is protected by the Constitution under the ten’s amendment, “The powers not delegated to the United States by the Constitution, nor prohibited by it to the States, are reserved to the States respectively, or to the people”. The statement infers that the agreement between the government and the United States is more of a contract between the US and a state rather than a forced unbreakable binding. This is a fundamental right each state must have in order to protect themselves. The United States is not like a barbaric kingdom where a province does not want to be a part of a country it is considered a rebellion. The states absolutely have the right to separate, the same way people can move out of their countries and renounce their citizenship, cities and towns splitting into new towns, states splitting off into new states (Virginia), but when it is at the level of the state, things are different? What would stop Lincoln from going as far as banning citizens from leaving, would Lincoln be considered a king then. The southern states are a minority and succession is an absolute right used to protect ourselves from the north and from king Lincoln who does not follow the constitution.

In the end Lincoln is distrusted by the south for many valid reasons, like Lincoln promising no interference with slavery despite his career going against slavery. He went out of

his way to try to start a war which could potentially destroy the country's economy and kill millions of families. Lastly he is going against the constitution by imposing a ban on secession.

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